



AP



ON THE PLATE

Close to a dozen agreements and MoUs on economic cooperation, trade, railways, coal and culture expected to be signed

Pacts on counter-terrorism, energy security and climate change likely

No major breakthrough on the border dispute expected but talks to be accelerated

Sino-Indian Medical Mission & festival of India in China to be announced

CHINESE CHECKERS: (left) Wen and Manmohan at the ASEAN summit; (above) Indian and Chinese soldiers patrol the border

a common strategy on the issue. Manmohan and Wen have met several times on the sidelines of multilateral meetings, and in a sense this visit will take forward the agenda. The prime minister was scheduled to visit China in 2007 but deferred it to 2008, with Congress President Sonia Gandhi instead paying a visit to China last year.

India will have to effectively volley off China's aggressive policies in Africa and Latin America, besides, in neighbouring countries such as Myanmar, Bangladesh and Nepal. Delhi will also have to factor in emerging threats such as the aggressive cyber militia—a large group of hackers being recruited by the People's Liberation Army—that targets strategic computer installations globally.

While Manmohan will have to do some firm talking on the border issue and achieve some progress on economic and global cooperation issues, the big task at hand will be to manage a vexed bilateral relationship by providing it some momentum. ■

gether on regional and global issues," remarked a senior South Block official. The new contours of global geopolitics will impact the visit which takes place at a juncture when India enjoys a close strategic relationship with almost all global powers. China also recognises India's growing clout in the international arena. The tenor of the visit will be a bit different as besides the usual bilateral chores, the focus will also be on strengthening cooperation on counter-terrorism, energy security, climate change and greater over-the-table cooperation at multilateral

organisations such as ASEAN.

China is getting increasingly worried because of Islamic terrorism which is affecting the province of Xinjiang. Recent developments in Pakistan and Afghanistan have forced the Asian superpower to be on the same page with India to look for strategies to counter terrorism. Recently, the two even exchanged information on counter-terrorism and the prime minister's visit will take that forward.

On climate change too, the two leaders share the same wavelength and are therefore expected to work on



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